reports indicated that China also reduced its state of alert on the Sino-Indian border, thus defusing the immediate crisis.[258]

The war made two things evident: first, that India still looked to the US for protection against China, especially since the Soviet Union showed little inclination to get involved (other than urging a ceasefire). Second, the war made apparent that as long as US administrations remained caught up in the Cold War web they had spun for Asia, for geopolitical, ideological, and domestic political reasons they could not see India fall to China. During the war, the US had initially stayed neutral and fairly indifferent. The moment China had entered the fray, however, the stakes had changed for the US.

On the other hand, the war also reinforced Johnson's sense that India was not an asset that could be built up against China, but rather a liability whose weakness threatened US interests and his agenda. The lack of a firm commitment against China also made Indian policymakers question the reliability of US assurances. Furthermore, Moscow refraining from suspending military assistance—while Washington had done so—reminded Delhi of the benefits of diversifying its partnerships.